

TOP NEWS TIMES

2026년 9월 21일 ~ 9월 27일 · 제39주호

On Air · Daniel

10편 수록



이번 호 기사

01	문화	Volunteers Bring Community Theaters Back to Life	2
02	경제	Where the World's Used Clothes End Up	3
03	스포츠	When Pro Sports Teams Leave Their Cities	4
04	세계	Panama Canal Faces a Growing Water Crisis	5
05	기술	Satellite Internet Reaches the World's Most Remote Places	6
06	환경	The World Is Running Out of Sand	7
07	건강	When the Nearest Delivery Room Is Miles Away	8
08	사회	Empty Storefronts Reshape City Centers Worldwide	9
09	기술	Data Centers Are Draining Our Water Supplies	10
10	경제	Three Years of Rising Coffee Prices	11

Volunteers Bring Community Theaters Back to Life

By Daniel · 2026-09-21 · 296 words · L2



마을 극장을 되살린 사람들

Small community theaters around the world were once facing permanent closure, but now local volunteers, artists, and residents are working together to bring them back to life.

Community theater has a long and meaningful history in many towns and cities. Before streaming services and multiplexes took over, local playhouses were central to everyday community life. People gathered there not just to watch performances, but also to meet their neighbors and share meaningful experiences together. As operating costs rose steadily and audiences began to shrink, many of these beloved spaces eventually went dark.

The revival effort looks quite different depending on where it takes place. In some towns, volunteers repair old buildings and raise funds through small community events and local fundraisers. In others, local artists offer free workshops specifically designed to attract new and younger audiences to the theater. What these efforts consistently share is a strong belief that professional theater is not the only kind that truly matters to people.

Researchers who study the arts point out that when local theaters close, communities often lose far more than just a performance stage. They lose a valuable gathering space that actively supports mental well-being and a shared sense of

belonging among residents. That argument has encouraged more people to get involved, even those with no prior performance experience at all.

Some local governments have begun to take notice of this growing movement. Modest grants and community development funds have already helped several theaters stay open or successfully reopen their doors. Arts supporters say this kind of public investment pays off — not just culturally, but socially, since shared creative spaces can significantly strengthen community bonds over time.

The future of community theater ultimately depends on continued local commitment and sustained public support from residents who care.

한글 요약

전 세계 소규모 지역 극장들이 운영난으로 잇따라 폐관 위기를 맞은 가운데, 지역 주민과 예술가, 자원봉사자들이 협력하여 이를 되살리려는 움직임이 활발히 전개되고 있다. 연구자들은 지역 극장이 단순한 공연 공간을 넘어 주민들의 정신 건강과 공동체 소속감을 증진하는 중요한 사회적 공간임을 강조한다. 일부 지방 정부는 보조금과 지역 개발 기금을 통해 이러한 공간의 보존과 재개관을 적극 지원하고 있으며, 예술 지지자들은 이 같은 공공 투자가 문화적·사회적으로 가시적인 성과를 낳는다고 주장한다. 지역 사회 극장의 지속적인 존립은 결국 주민들의 꾸준한 관심과 공공의 지속적인 지원에 달려 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

closure 폐쇄, 문을 닫음

volunteer 자원봉사자

revival 부활, 되살림

playhouse 소극장, 공연장

multiplex 복합 영화관

workshop 워크숍, 실습 수업

gathering 모임, 집합

well-being 행복, 건강한 상태

modest 적당한, 소박한

grant 보조금, 지원금

fragility 취약함, 불안정함

investment 투자

bond 유대, 결속

venue 공연 장소, 행사장

Where the World's Used Clothes End Up

By Daniel · 2026-09-21 · 262 words · L2



중고 의류가 도착하는 나라

Every year, wealthy countries export billions of dollars' worth of secondhand clothing to developing nations. These garments — sorted, bundled, and shipped in large bales — travel to markets across Africa, South Asia, and Latin America, where they are resold at low prices. For many buyers, they represent affordable fashion. For the countries receiving them, the story is more complicated.

Ghana is one of the world's largest destinations for used clothing. The Kantamanto market in the capital, Accra, is among the biggest secondhand clothing markets on the planet. Traders buy bales sight unseen

from importers, not knowing what is inside until they cut them open. A large share of what arrives turns out to be worn out or simply unsellable.

Clothing that cannot be sold often ends up in landfills or washes into rivers and eventually onto beaches. Environmental groups have documented serious pollution along Ghana's coastline, where piles of discarded textiles have built up over the years. Similar scenes have been reported in Kenya and other parts of sub-Saharan Africa.

Chile's Atacama Desert presents another striking example. Used

clothing enters through the port of Iquique, a duty-free zone, and floods local markets. Whatever remains unsold is frequently dumped in the desert, creating massive textile waste fields that are visible from the air.

Supporters of the secondhand trade argue that it creates jobs and gives low-income households access to affordable clothes. Critics, however, say rich countries are effectively exporting their waste problem. As fast fashion continues to drive up clothing production globally, the pressure on receiving countries is only expected to grow.

한글 요약

선진국들은 매년 수십억 달러 규모의 중고 의류를 아프리카, 남아시아, 라틴아메리카 등 개발도상국에 수출하고 있다. 가나의 칸타만토 시장, 칠레의 아타카마 사막 등지에서는 판매되지 못한 의류가 매립지와 자연환경에 무단 투기되어 심각한 환경오염을 유발하고 있다. 중고 의류 거래가 일자리 창출과 저렴한 소비재 공급이라는 순기능을 갖는다는 주장도 있으나, 비판론자들은 부유한 나라들이 폐기물 문제를 사실상 수출하고 있다고 지적한다. 패스트패션으로 인해 전 세계 의류 생산량이 지속적으로 증가함에 따라, 수입국들이 감당해야 할 부담은 앞으로 더욱 커질 것으로 우려된다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

export 수출하다

garment 의류, 옷

bale (압축된) 묶음, 꾸러미

affordable 가격이 적당한, 저렴한

destination 목적지, 도착지

importer 수입업자

unsellable 팔 수 없는

landfill 매립지

pollution 오염

discard 버리다, 폐기하다

duty-free 면세의

textile 직물, 섬유

effectively 사실상, 실질적으로

fast fashion 패스트 패션 (저가 대량 의류 산업)

When Pro Sports Teams Leave Their Cities

By Daniel · 2026-09-21 · 150 words · L1



프로 구단의 연고지 이전

When a professional sports team moves to a new city, it can break the hearts of fans left behind. This is called a franchise relocation, and it happens more often than many people realize. In the United States, teams in major leagues like the NFL, NBA, and MLB have moved dozens of times over the past several decades.

One recent example is the Oakland Athletics baseball team. After more than 50 years in Oakland,

California, the team relocated to Las Vegas in 2025. Many longtime fans felt angry and abandoned. Local businesses near the old stadium also lost customers who used to come for game days.

Teams usually move because of money. Owners look for cities that offer newer stadiums, larger fan bases, or better financial deals. However, the original city often loses tax income and jobs as a result. Some fans never support the team again after it leaves.

한글 요약

프로 스포츠 구단의 연고지 이전, 즉 프랜차이즈 이전은 미국 주요 리그에서 수십 년간 수십 차례 발생해온 현상이다. 오�클랜드 애슬레틱스는 50년 이상의 오�클랜드 시대를 마감하고 2025년 라스베이거스로 이전하였으며, 이는 팬들의 분노와 지역 상권 침체를 초래하였다. 구단 이전의 주된 원인은 신규 경기장, 더 넓은 팬 기반, 유리한 재정 조건 등 경제적 요인이다. 반면 기존 도시는 세수 감소와 일자리 손실이라는 부담을 떠안게 되며, 일부 팬들은 구단이 떠난 후 영원히 등을 돌리기도 한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

professional 프로의, 직업적인

franchise 프랜차이즈, 특정 팀이나 사업권

relocation 이전, 이사

decade 10년

relocate 이전하다, 이사하다

abandoned 버려진

stadium 경기장

longtime 오랫동안의

financial 재정적인, 금융의

tax 세금

income 수입, 소득

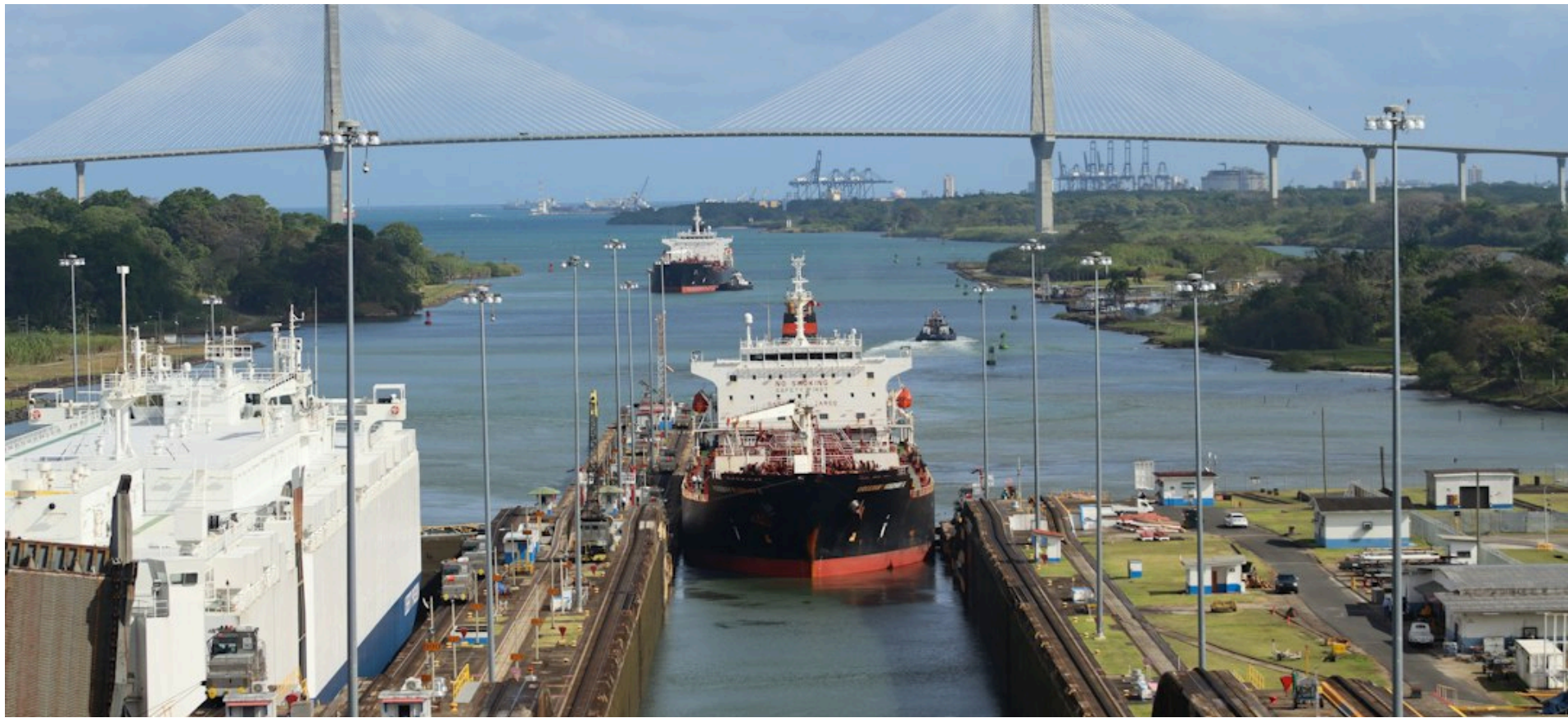
fan base 팬층, 팬 기반

owner 소유자, 구단주

support 지지하다, 응원하다

Panama Canal Faces a Growing Water Crisis

By Daniel · 2026-09-21 · 290 words · L2



파나마 운하의 가문

The Panama Canal is one of the world's most important shipping routes, connecting the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans through a narrow strip of land in Central America. Each year, thousands of cargo ships pass through it, carrying goods that affect prices and supply chains around the globe. But a serious water shortage is now threatening its ability to operate normally.

The canal does not use saltwater from the sea. Instead, it depends on freshwater from Gatun Lake, a large artificial lake created nearly a century ago. When ships pass through the canal's locks, huge amounts of water are released into the

ocean. This means the lake must be constantly refilled by rainfall and river flows.

In 2023, an unusually strong El Niño weather pattern brought severe drought to the region. Water levels in Gatun Lake dropped sharply, forcing canal authorities to reduce the number of ships allowed to pass each day by more than a third. Some vessels waited weeks for their turn, causing delays and rising shipping costs worldwide.

To prevent similar disruptions in the future, Panamanian authorities have proposed building a new dam to create an additional water reservoir. However, the plan has faced strong opposition

from farming communities whose land would be flooded. Local residents worry about losing their homes and livelihoods, turning the water shortage into both an environmental and a social issue.

Climate scientists warn that droughts in the region could become more frequent as global temperatures rise. For a waterway that handles roughly three percent of global trade, finding a reliable long-term solution is urgent. The challenge facing Panama — balancing the canal's needs with those of its own people — reflects a tension that many countries around the world are beginning to feel.

한글 요약

파나마 운하는 가툰 호수의 담수에 의존해 운영되는데, 2023년 강력한 엘 니뇨로 인한 극심한 가뭄으로 수위가 급락하면서 하루 통항 선박 수가 3분의 1 이상 감축되었다. 이로 인해 전 세계적으로 물류 지연과 해상 운송 비용 상승이 발생하였다. 파나마 당국은 추가 저수지 확보를 위한 댐 건설을 추진하고 있으나, 수몰 위기에 처한 지역 주민들의 강한 반대로 환경·사회적 갈등이 심화되고 있다. 기후 변화로 가뭄이 더욱 잦아질 것으로 전망되는 가운데, 전 세계 교역량의 약 3%를 담당하는 이 운하의 지속 가능한 운영을 위한 장기적 해결책 마련이 시급한 과제로 부상하고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

shipping 해운, 선박 운송
route 경로, 항로
shortage 부족, 결핍
artificial 인공의
lock (운하의) 갑문
drought 가뭄
reservoir 저수지

disruption 혼란, 차질
opposition 반대
livelihood 생계
frequent 빈번한
reliable 믿을 수 있는, 안정적인
tension 긴장, 갈등
vessel 선박, 배

Satellite Internet Reaches the World's Most Remote Places

By Daniel · 2026-09-21 · 262 words · L2



위성 인터넷이 닿는 오지

For roughly one-third of the world's population, reliable internet access remains out of reach. Many of these people live in mountainous regions, isolated islands, or vast rural areas where building cable or fiber networks is simply too costly. Satellite internet is now changing that picture.

Traditional satellites orbit at about 35,000 kilometers above Earth. At that distance, signals take a noticeable amount of time to travel back and forth, making video calls and real-time applications frustrating. A newer generation of satellites, however, flies much lower — at altitudes between

500 and 1,200 kilometers — and delivers far faster, more responsive connections.

Companies like SpaceX, with its Starlink service, and Amazon, with its Project Kuiper, are launching hundreds of these low-Earth orbit satellites to form large networks in space. Starlink already serves customers in over 100 countries, including remote communities in northern Canada, rural Alaska, and parts of sub-Saharan Africa that had little or no internet before.

The benefits go beyond convenience. Schools in isolated villages can access online learning resources. Healthcare workers can send patient data to distant

hospitals. Analysts note that reliable connectivity in remote areas can raise local economic activity and improve public services significantly.

Still, challenges remain. Monthly subscription costs can be high for low-income communities, and the equipment needed to connect is not cheap. Some experts also point to concerns about space congestion, as thousands of new satellites increase the risk of collisions in orbit. How governments and companies manage these issues will shape whether satellite internet truly delivers on its promise for the world's most disconnected communities.

한글 요약

전 세계 인구의 약 3분의 1은 산악 지대나 오지에 거주하며 안정적인 인터넷 접속이 어려운 환경에 놓여 있으나, 스페이스X의 스타링크와 아마존의 프로젝트 카이퍼 등이 저궤도 위성망을 구축하면서 이러한 상황이 변화하고 있다. 저궤도 위성은 기존 정지궤도 위성보다 훨씬 낮은 고도를 비행해 신호 지연이 적고 반응 속도가 빠르며, 현재 100개국 이상에서 서비스가 제공되고 있다. 오지 학교의 온라인 교육 접근, 원격 의료 데이터 전송 등 사회·경제적 파급 효과도 주목받고 있다. 다만 높은 구독 요금과 장비 비용, 궤도 혼잡으로 인한 위성 충돌 위험 등의 과제가 남아 있어 정부와 기업의 정책적 대응이 향후 위성 인터넷의 보편화 여부를 결정지을 것으로 전망된다.

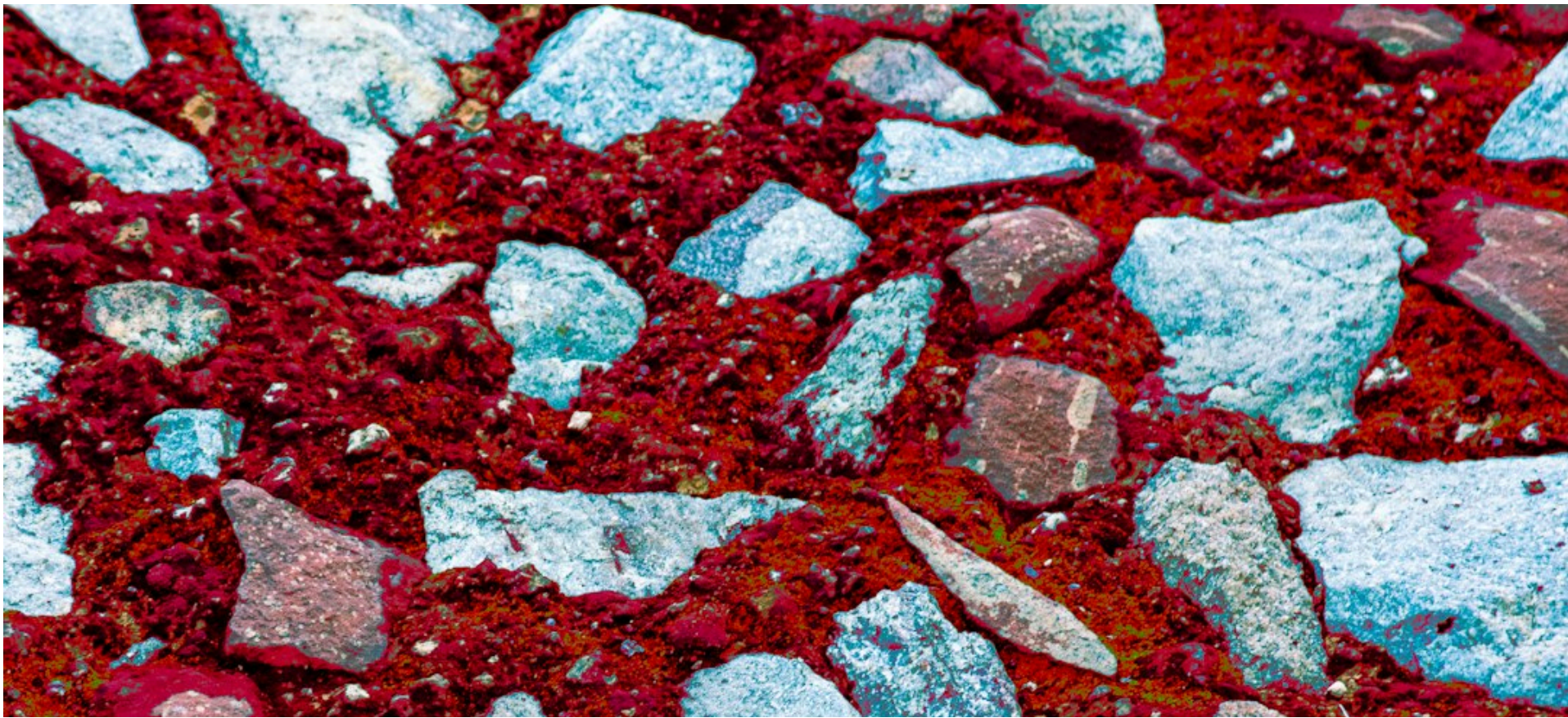
WORDS & MEANINGS

reliable 믿을 수 있는, 안정적인
isolated 고립된, 외딴
fiber 광섬유
orbit 궤도; 궤도를 돌다
altitude 고도
responsive 반응이 빠른
launch 발사하다; 시작하다

constellation (위성) 군집, 별자리
connectivity 연결성
subscription 구독, 가입
congestion 혼잡, 과밀
collision 충돌
significant 상당한, 중요한
disconnected 연결이 끊긴, 고립된

The World Is Running Out of Sand

By Daniel · 2026-09-21 · 300 words · L3



사라지는 모래와 건설업

Sand is one of the most widely used natural resources on Earth, yet most people never think twice about it. Every year, the world consumes an estimated 40 to 50 billion tonnes of sand and gravel — enough to cover the entire country of England in a thick layer.

The construction industry is by far the largest user. Sand is a key ingredient in concrete, glass, and asphalt, making it essential for building roads, bridges, and cities. As urban populations have grown rapidly across Asia, Africa, and the Middle East, demand for sand has risen sharply over the past two decades.

The problem is that not all sand can be used for construction. Desert sand is too

smooth and rounded from wind erosion to bond properly in concrete. The sand that builders need comes mostly from riverbeds, lakes, and coastlines — places where extraction causes serious environmental damage.

When sand is removed from rivers faster than nature can replace it, riverbanks become unstable and fish habitats are destroyed. Surrounding farmland can also start to sink. Some rivers in Southeast Asia have already lost significant portions of their beds due to heavy mining.

The shortage has also created a black market. Criminal networks in countries such as India, Vietnam, and parts of

West Africa now control illegal sand mining operations worth billions of dollars annually. These networks are reported to be highly organized, and local officials are sometimes alleged to ignore what is happening.

Monitoring of sand extraction has struggled to keep pace with the speed of demand, leaving many vulnerable ecosystems without adequate protection.

Without stronger international regulation and wider adoption of alternatives — such as recycled materials and industrial by-products — the pressure on the world's sand supplies is likely to keep growing alongside the demand for new infrastructure.

한글 요약

모래는 건설 산업의 핵심 원료로, 전 세계에서 매년 400억~500억 톤이 소비되지만 건설에 적합한 모래는 강바닥과 해안 등 특정 지역에서만 채취 가능하다. 이러한 무분별한 채굴은 강둑 붕괴, 어류 서식지 파괴, 농경지 침하 등 심각한 환경 문제를 야기하고 있다. 모래 부족 현상은 인도, 베트남, 서아프리카 등지에서 연간 수십억 달러 규모의 불법 채굴 시장을 형성하는 결과로도 이어졌다. 전문가들은 강력한 국제 규제 마련과 재활용 소재 등 대체재 도입 없이는 모래 공급에 대한 압박이 지속적으로 증가할 것이라고 경고한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

resource 자원

consume 소비하다

ingredient 재료, 성분

essential 필수적인

extraction 채취, 추출

erosion 침식

unstable 불안정한

habitat 서식지

shortage 부족, 결핍

criminal 범죄의, 범죄자

regulation 규제

adoption 채택

infrastructure 기반시설

monitoring 감시, 모니터링

When the Nearest Delivery Room Is Miles Away

By Daniel · 2026-09-21 · 276 words · L2



병원 없는 지역의 분만실

For many pregnant women in rural areas, the local hospital no longer offers a place to give birth. Across the United States, more than half of rural hospitals have closed their labor and delivery units in recent years, leaving entire communities without access to maternity care close to home.

This growing shortage has a name: maternity care deserts. These are counties where there are no hospitals with obstetric services and no midwives or obstetricians practicing locally. Experts say the number of such areas has been rising steadily, particularly in states with large rural populations.

Hospitals point to shrinking budgets and falling birth rates as the main reasons for closing these units. Running a safe delivery ward requires round-the-clock staffing by trained nurses, doctors, and anesthesiologists — costs that become very difficult to cover when the number of births drops below a certain level each year.

The consequences can be serious. When a complication arises during labor, every minute matters. Women in maternity care deserts may need to travel an hour or more to reach a hospital, raising the risk of dangerous outcomes for both mother and baby. Health researchers note that maternal

mortality rates tend to be higher in rural areas than in cities.

Some organizations are trying new approaches to fill the gap. Mobile health clinics, for example, have been deployed in parts of Florida to bring prenatal checkups and maternal health services directly to underserved communities. Telehealth services, which connect patients with doctors by video, are also expanding. Whether these solutions can fully replace a hospital delivery room remains an open question, but they are giving more women access to at least basic care.

한글 요약

미국 농촌 병원의 절반 이상이 분만 병동을 폐쇄하면서, 산과 서비스나 전문 의료 인력이 전무한 이른바 '산모 의료 사각지대'가 꾸준히 증가하고 있다. 병원들은 예산 부족과 출생률 저하를 주된 원인으로 들고 있으며, 이로 인해 농촌 지역의 모성 사망률이 도시보다 높게 나타나는 등 심각한 결과가 초래되고 있다. 이러한 공백을 해소하기 위해 이동형 의료 클리닉과 원격 의료 서비스 같은 대안적 접근이 시도되고 있다. 그러나 이러한 방안이 병원 분만실의 역할을 온전히 대체할 수 있을지는 아직 불분명한 상황이다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

- rural 농촌의, 시골의
- maternity 출산(의), 임산부(의)
- obstetric 산과(産科)의
- obstetrician 산부인과 의사
- midwife 조산사
- anesthesiologist 마취과 의사
- complication 합병증, 문제

- mortality 사망률
- prenatal 출산 전의, 산전(産前)의
- deploy 배치하다, 투입하다
- underserved 서비스가 부족한, 혜택을 받지 못하는
- telehealth 원격 의료
- shortage 부족, 결핍
- staffing 인력 배치, 직원 충원

Empty Storefronts Reshape City Centers Worldwide

By Daniel · 2026-09-21 · 274 words · L2



빈 상가가 늘어난 도심

Walk through many city centers today and the signs are hard to miss: boarded-up windows, faded 'For Rent' notices, and streets that once buzzed with shoppers now standing eerily quiet. The rise of empty storefronts has become one of the most visible urban challenges of the 2020s.

The shift began well before the pandemic, driven largely by the growth of online shopping. When the pandemic then forced millions of workers to stay home, foot traffic in downtown areas fell sharply, and many small businesses could no longer afford the rent. In cities like Montreal and several major American cities, vacancy rates in

downtown retail zones climbed to levels not seen in decades.

Remote work has made the problem harder to solve. When office workers no longer commute five days a week, nearby cafés, clothing shops, and service businesses lose a reliable base of customers. Some US cities have responded by waiving business registration fees or offering small grants to attract new tenants into empty units.

Urban planners suggest that the solution may involve rethinking what downtown spaces are actually for. Rather than waiting for traditional retail to return, some cities are converting empty

storefronts into community centers, co-working spaces, or small creative studios. These uses can bring people back without depending entirely on consumer spending.

The trend also raises a question worth considering: what kind of city do residents actually want? Downtown areas have historically been defined by commerce, but shifting habits may push cities toward more mixed-use neighborhoods where living, working, and leisure exist side by side. How quickly cities adapt to this new reality may determine the long-term health of their centers.

한글 요약

온라인 쇼핑의 확산과 팬데믹, 그리고 원격 근무의 정착으로 인해 전 세계 많은 도심에서 상가 공실률이 수십 년 만의 최고 수준으로 치솟았다. 일부 미국 도시들은 수수료 면제와 보조금 지원 등의 정책으로 새 임차인 유치에 나서고 있으나, 근본적인 해결책으로는 미흡하다는 평가다. 도시 계획가들은 빈 상가를 커뮤니티 센터나 공유 업무 공간으로 전환하는 등 도심 공간의 용도 자체를 재정의해야 한다고 제안하고 있다. 앞으로의 도시는 상업 중심의 단일 기능에서 벗어나 주거·업무·여가가 공존하는 복합 용도 공간으로 진화할 가능성이 높으며, 이에 대한 도시들의 적응 속도가 도시의 장기적인 활력을 결정지을 것이다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

storefront 상점 전면, 점포
vacancy 공실, 빈 자리
foot traffic 유동 인구
commute 통근하다
tenant 세입자, 임차인
grant 보조금
retail 소매업

convert 전환하다, 바꾸다
urban 도시의
commerce 상업, 무역
leisure 여가
mixed-use 복합 용도의
visible 눈에 띄는, 가시적인
reliable 믿을 수 있는, 안정적인

Data Centers Are Draining Our Water Supplies

By Daniel · 2026-09-21 · 262 words · L2



데이터센터가 마시는 물

Every time someone uses an AI chatbot or streams a video, a data center somewhere is working hard — and using a surprising amount of water to stay cool. These large facilities house thousands of servers that generate enormous heat, and cooling them requires water in quantities that many people would find shocking.

Data centers use water in two main ways. Some systems pump water directly through cooling equipment. Others use water to chill the air around the servers. In both cases, much of that water evaporates and is lost permanently.

The scale of this consumption is significant. A single large data center can use millions of liters of water each day — roughly as much as a small city. As AI tools become more popular and more powerful, the demand for data center capacity keeps growing, and so does their water use.

What makes this issue more complex is a lack of transparency. Most tech companies do not publicly report exactly how much water their facilities consume. Environmental groups say this makes it very difficult to assess the true impact on local water supplies,

especially in dry regions where water is already scarce.

Some companies have begun publishing annual water reports and setting reduction targets. Microsoft, for example, has pledged to replenish more water than it uses by 2030. However, critics say voluntary commitments are not enough and that stronger regulations are needed. As global demand for AI continues to rise, how the tech industry manages its water footprint will likely become one of the defining environmental questions of the decade.

한글 요약

AI 챗봇 및 스트리밍 서비스의 확산으로 데이터 센터의 물 사용량이 급증하고 있으며, 대형 시설 하나가 하루에 소비하는 물의 양은 소규모 도시의 수준에 달한다. 데이터 센터는 서버 냉각을 위해 물을 직접 순환시키거나 공기를 냉각하는 방식을 사용하는데, 이 과정에서 상당량의 물이 증발하여 영구적으로 소실된다. 대부분의 기술 기업들이 물 사용량을 공개하지 않아 투명성 부재 문제가 지적되고 있으며, 특히 건조 지역의 수자원에 미치는 영향을 파악하기 어렵다는 우려가 제기되고 있다. 마이크로소프트와 같은 일부 기업이 자발적인 감축 목표를 발표하고 있으나, 비판론자들은 보다 강력한 규제가 뒷받침되어야 한다고 주장한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

facility 시설

server 서버 (데이터를 저장하고 처리하는 컴퓨터)

enormous 거대한, 어마어마한

evaporate 증발하다

consumption 소비(량)

capacity 수용력, 처리 능력

transparency 투명성

assess 평가하다

scarce 부족한, 희귀한

replenish 보충하다

voluntary 자발적인

commitment 약속, 헌신

regulation 규정, 규제

footprint (환경적) 발자국, 영향

Three Years of Rising Coffee Prices

By Daniel · 2026-09-21 · 277 words · L2



커피 원두 값이 오른 3년

The price of coffee has been climbing for nearly three years, and there is no clear sign of it slowing down. Arabica bean prices on global markets hit record highs in early 2025, pushing up costs for cafes and consumers around the world.

The main driver is weather. Brazil and Vietnam — the world's two largest coffee producers — have both suffered from droughts and extreme heat linked to climate change. Brazil grows more than a third of the world's coffee supply, so when its harvests fall short, global prices feel the impact almost immediately.

Vietnam is the leading producer of Robusta beans, which are used in instant coffee and espresso blends. Dry conditions there in 2023 and 2024 cut output sharply. With both major suppliers struggling at the same time, the global supply gap widened and prices rose further.

Financial investors have added pressure to the market. When traders expect shortages, they buy futures contracts — agreements to purchase coffee at a set price later. This activity pushes prices up even before the shortage actually arrives. Analysts say this kind of speculative buying has made recent price swings larger than usual.

For consumers, the effects are clear. Major coffee chains have raised their prices, and supermarket brands have followed. Some buyers in Asia and Europe are switching to cheaper alternatives, while others are simply paying more.

Experts say the deeper problem is that coffee farming has not adapted fast enough to changing climate conditions. Many growers still rely on traditional methods in regions that are becoming less suitable for the crop. Without investment in climate-resistant farming, another price spike may be only one bad harvest away.

한글 요약

세계 커피 가격이 약 3년째 오름세를 지속하며 2025년 초 아라비카 원두 가격이 사상 최고치를 기록했다. 브라질과 베트남 등 주요 생산국에서 기후변화로 인한 가뭄과 폭염이 동시에 발생하면서 공급 부족이 심화된 것이 핵심 원인이다. 여기에 선물 시장에서의 투기적 매수가 더해지며 가격 변동 폭이 더욱 확대되었고, 주요 커피 체인과 유통 업체들이 줄줄이 가격을 인상하면서 소비자 부담이 가중되고 있다. 전문가들은 기후 저항성 농업에 대한 투자가 이루어지지 않는 한 추가적인 가격 급등이 반복될 수 있다고 경고한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

producer 생산국, 생산자

harvest 수확, 수확물

drought 가뭄

supply 공급, 공급량

output 생산량

shortage 부족, 공급 부족

futures contract 선물 계약

speculative 투기적인

swing 변동, 급등락

alternative 대안, 대체품

espresso 에스프레소

climate-resistant 기후 변화에 강한

adapt 적응하다

spike 급등, 급격한 상승

스크랩하기Scrap It!

이름날짜학교 · 반

1. 이번 호 기사 목록 — 스크랩할 기사에 표시하세요

- ☐ 문화Volunteers Bring Community Theaters Back to Life
- ☐ 경제Where the World's Used Clothes End Up
- ☐ 스포츠When Pro Sports Teams Leave Their Cities
- ☐ 세계Panama Canal Faces a Growing Water Crisis
- ☐ 기술Satellite Internet Reaches the World's Most Remote Places
- ☐ 환경The World Is Running Out of Sand
- ☐ 건강When the Nearest Delivery Room Is Miles Away
- ☐ 사회Empty Storefronts Reshape City Centers Worldwide
- ☐ 기술Data Centers Are Draining Our Water Supplies
- ☐ 경제Three Years of Rising Coffee Prices

2. 스크랩할 기사 · 제목과 섹션

3. 기사 요약 (3문장)

4. 새로 배운 단어 5개 · 뜻

5. 내 생각 · 이 기사가 중요한 이유